Errata

On Coppock, Ekins and Kirby (2018), *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 13(1)

This note lists ten corrections to "The Long-lasting Effects of Newspaper Op-Eds on Public Opinion," published in the *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 13(1), doi 10.1561/100.00016112. **None of them changes a conclusion of the paper.** The first seven are sentences in the body text that disagree with a table the same article prints, and in each case the table is right and the sentence is not. The last three are errors in the reference list. The tables themselves, and the findings they carry, are unaffected.

Every number in a corrected sentence below is computed from the deposited replication archive (10.7910/DVN/3KBCJF) at the time this document is rendered, including the numbers that were not wrong. The code and output supporting each correction are at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/coppock_ekins_kirby_2018.

Bold marks what changed. The first three entries are substantive: a comparison that reverses direction on one of four op-eds, a significance level overstated by an order of magnitude, and a miscount of the cells of a table. Entries 4 through 7 are undercounted sample sizes, each of which the adjacent table gives correctly.

1. The elite sample did not read for 25 to 45 seconds less

> On average, our elite sample spent 25–45 seconds less time reading our treatment articles than the MTurk sample.

Corrected:

> On average, our elite sample spent **17.4** seconds less time reading our treatment articles than the MTurk sample.

Across the four op-eds both samples saw, the elite deficit in trimmed mean reading time is 45.6 seconds on the flat tax piece, 28.5 seconds on the Wall Street piece and 26.4 seconds on the Amtrak piece, and on the veterans piece the elite sample spent 30.7 seconds **more**, not less. The published range brackets the two arms the deposit's `opeds_compliance.R` computes, the Amtrak and flat tax pieces; the two it does not compute are the ones that break the range.

2. The elite main-effect significance level

> Turning first to main dependent variables, we found statistically significant treatment effects for three of the four treatments (Amtrak, Flat Tax, Wall Street) at $p < 0.001$, but did not for the Veterans op-ed treatment.

Corrected:

> Turning first to main dependent variables, we found statistically significant treatment effects for three of the four treatments (Amtrak, Flat Tax, Wall Street) at $p <$ **0.01**, but did not for the Veterans op-ed treatment.

The flat tax effect on its main dependent variable has $p = 0.0042$. Table 6 prints it as `0.411***` under a legend whose strongest level is $p < 0.01$, so the table and the sentence disagree about the same estimate. The Amtrak and Wall Street effects are significant at 0.001; the flat tax effect is not.

3. Table 7 has twelve non-target cells, not sixteen

> Of the 16 treatment effects on non-target issues, only one is statistically significant (Amtrak op-ed on Veterans outcome).

Corrected:

> Of the **12** treatment effects on non-target issues, only one is statistically significant (Amtrak op-ed on Veterans outcome).

Table 7 estimates four op-ed effects on each of four composite scales, so it holds 16 coefficients, of which four are on target and 12 are not. The parallel sentence about Table 3 counts correctly: five op-eds by five outcomes is 25 coefficients and 20 non-target ones.

4. The number of elite subjects who completed the survey

> This procedure yielded 2,169 subjects who completed our survey.

Corrected:

> This procedure yielded **2,181** subjects who completed our survey.

Table 5, at the top of the same page, gives 2,181 as its own total, and that is the number of rows in the deposited elite data. Tables 6 and 7 report the same figure as their N.

5. The number of elite subjects who responded in Wave 2

> As in the MTurk study, we asked subjects to participate in a follow-up survey after 10 days; after two reminders, we obtained 1,349 complete responses.

Corrected:

> As in the MTurk study, we asked subjects to participate in a follow-up survey after 10 days; after two reminders, we obtained **1,358** complete responses.

Table 5's Responded row totals 1,358.

6. The number of subjects enrolled on Mechanical Turk

> We enrolled 3,567 subjects on Amazon's Mechanical Turk (MTurk) in a three-wave panel survey.

Corrected:

> We enrolled **3,571** subjects on Amazon's Mechanical Turk (MTurk) in a three-wave panel survey.

Table 1 gives 3,571 as its own total, and every column of Tables 3 and 4 reports the same figure as its N.

7. The range of average treatment effects reported in the Discussion

> In both studies of the mass public and elites, we find large, statistically significant average treatment effects of op-eds between 0.30 and 0.50 standard deviations on policy attitudes.

Corrected:

> In both studies of the mass public and elites, we find large, statistically significant average treatment effects of op-eds between **0.28 and 0.52** standard deviations on policy attitudes.

The sentence pairs one figure with each study, so the two numbers are the study-level means over the on-target composite scales: 0.283 across the 4 elite op-eds and 0.522 across the 5 on Mechanical Turk. Neither figure is hedged, so the interval is asserted as printed, and both means fall outside it. The individual effects run wider still, from 0.104 to 0.698.

The reference list

The three entries below correct the article's reference list. Each was found by an audit that sends every printed entry whole to Crossref and checks the authoritative record back into it, and each is verified against the record named in its note. No cited work is missing and no citation in the text points at the wrong work: what is wrong is how the reference list prints the authors. In these three entries bold marks the wrong reading as printed, since a reference entry has no surrounding sentence to locate it in.

8. Traverso is misspelled, in the reference list and in the text

Published, p. 84:

> Ciofalo, A. and K. **Traveso**. 1994.

Corrected:

> Ciofalo, A. and K. Traverso. 1994.

Crossref, doi 10.1177/073953299401500407: Ciofalo, Andrew, and Kim Traverso. The same misspelling appears in the two in-text citations, on pp. 61 and 63.

9. Calavita and Krumholz (2003) is printed as one author, filed under his given name

Published, p. 86:

> **Nico Calavita, N. K.** 2003.

Corrected:

> Calavita, N. and N. Krumholz. 2003.

Crossref, doi 10.1177/0739456x03022004006: Calavita, Nico, and Norman Krumholz. The first author's given name was taken as part of his surname and the second author's initials were folded onto it, leaving one author where there are two. The in-text citation on p. 60 reads "Nico Calavita, 2003" and should read "Calavita and Krumholz, 2003".

10. Two authors of Page, Shapiro and Dempsey (1987) are given by their given names

Published, p. 86:

> Page, B. I., **Y. S. Robert, and D. Glenn**. 1987. "What Moves Public Opinion?" American Political Science Review **81**.

Corrected:

> Page, B. I., R. Y. Shapiro, and G. R. Dempsey. 1987. "What Moves Public Opinion?" American Political Science Review 81(1): 23–43.

Crossref, doi 10.2307/1960777: Page, Benjamin I., Robert Y. Shapiro and Glenn R. Dempsey, American Political Science Review 81(1): 23–43. Robert Shapiro's and Glenn Dempsey's given names were taken for their surnames, and the entry breaks off after the volume number. The in-text citation on p. 63 gives "Page et al. (1987)" correctly.